NESA NATIONAL EXAMINATION AND SCHOOL INSPECTION AUTHORITY

GSCS EXAMINATION

2024
2025

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NESA Past Papers: General Studies and Communication Skills (2025) | Answers

Target Subject: General Studies and Communication Skills **Combinations:** All Science, Humanities, and Languages Combinations, Accounting Profession **Exam Year:** 2024-2025

This comprehensive guide covers all questions from Section A, B, and C to help students fully prepare for their REB/NESA Advanced Level National Examinations.

Section A: Attempt all questions in this section (55 marks)

For all multiple choice questions, circle a letter corresponding to the correct answer.

1) "What is the role of the Rwanda Media Commission?" (3 marks)

The Rwanda Media Commission (RMC) is the self-regulatory body for the media sector in Rwanda. Its primary roles include protecting journalists, regulating daily media content, advocating for media freedom, and handling complaints against the media or by the media to ensure professional and ethical journalism.

2) Which four of the following are examples of chosen Pluralism? Circle the cor rect answers. (4 marks)

A) Ethnicity

B) Ideological views

C) Religious

D) Occupational or professional views

E) Height and native language

F) Political views

G) Gender

H) Race

Correct answers

B

C

D

F

Explanation: Chosen (or acquired) pluralism refers to identities or affiliations that an individual voluntarily adopts or changes over time, as opposed to "given" biological traits.

3) Read the following statements and indicate whether they are True or False. (4 marks)

A) Financial institutions only serve individuals and not businesses.

False

B) The primary role of financial institutions is to offer long-term loans for housing development only.

False

C) Insurance company is a type of financial institution that helps individuals protect themselves against financial loss.

True

D) Microfinance institutions offer loans to individuals who cannot access traditional banking services.

True

4) Which three of the following strategies are related to preventing future occurrence of genocide in Rwanda? Circle the correct answers. (3 marks)

A) Resilience

B) Dictatorship

C) Inclusiveness

D) Intolerance

E) Reconciliation

F) Media censorship

Correct

A) Resilience

C) Inclusiveness

E) Reconciliation

5) Match each environmental issue with the proposed solution to address it. (5 marks)

Environmental issue	Proposed Solution
i) Deforestation	a) Reduce emissions by using cleaner technologies in industries and transportation.
ii) Air Pollution	b) Plant more trees and implement sustainable forestry practices.
iii) Ocean Acidification	c) Protect marine ecosystems and reduce CO2 emissions to the atmosphere.
iv) Soil Erosion	d) Transition to renewable energy sources such as wind or solar
v) Global Warming	e) Reduce the use of chemical fertilizers and practice crop rotation.

Correct

i)------ > b)

ii)------ > a)

iii)------ > c)

iv)------ >e)

v)------ > d)

6) i) Which of the following is an example of Traditional Art?

A) Sculpture

B) Photography using a digital camera

C) Digital painting created using computer software

D) None of the above

Correct

A

ii) Which one of the following is NOT an importance of Arts?

A) Art preserves history

B) It provides entertainment

C) It provides an avenue for self-expression

D) It discourages interpersonal communication

Correct

D

7) Fill in the blank spaces using the following concepts: (4 marks)

Gender-Based Violence (GBV), Physical abuse, Child Protection Act, gender

i) The term **Gender-Based Violence (GBV)** refers to any harmful act or threat towards a person due to their gender such as domestic violence, sexual harass ment, and trafficking.

ii) One of the key factors contributing to the high rates of GBV is **gender** inequality.

iii) **Physical abuse** is a type of child abuse where a child is intentionally harmed through physical force or violence.

iv) The **child protection act** is the legal framework that ensures children are protected from all forms of exploitation, abuse, and neglect.

8) Which of the following is considered as genre of Literature? (2 marks)

A) Novel

B) Songs

C) Poems

D) All of the above

Answer

D

9) Musoni bought a piece of land in January 2013 at a price of 280,000 Frw. If the value of the land appreciates at a rate of 10% at the beginning of each year, what was the value of the piece of land in January 2016? Circle the correct answer. (3 marks)

A) Rwf 308,000

B) Rwf 330,000

C) Rwf 372,680

D) Rwf 420,000

Correct

C

Explanation: **Calculation:** 280,000 Frw appreciating at 10% for 3 years (2013 to 2016).

10) Match each international financial institution with its primary role or function. (4 marks)

Column A	Column B
i) International Mone tary Fund (IMF)	a) Provides long-term loans for development projects and infrastructure.
ii) World Bank	b) Promotes global financial stability and provides emergency loans to countries facing balance of pay ments problems.
iii) International Fi nance Corporation (IFC)	c) Focuses on private sector development by providing financing and advisory services to businesses.
iv) Bank for Interna tional Settlements (BIS)	d) Acts as a central bank for central banks, promoting financial stability and fostering monetary coopera tion.

Correct

i)------ > b)

ii)------ > a)

iii)------ > c)

iv)------ > d)

11) Arrange the steps in the career planning process in the correct order. (4 marks)

Find out the academic and other requirements needed to secure the job

Set goals to achieve those requirements.

Consider the available options that would suit your interests and abilities

Consider your interests and talents

Answer

Consider your interests and talents

Consider the available options that would suit your interests and abilities

Find out the academic and other requirements needed to secure the job

Set goals to achieve those requirements

12) A farmer in a temperate region wants to control pests in a sustainable way without using harmful pesticides. Which three of the following practices would be effective for reducing pest infestation and conserving biodiversity? (3 marks)

A) Integrated pest management practices

B) Introduction of parasitic pests

C) Overuse of water resources

D) Monoculture farming

E) Natural pest elimination

F) Planting on slopes without terracing

Correct

A) Integrated pest management practices

B) Introduction of parasitic pests

E) Natural pest elimination

13) Circle the best answer from the given alternatives. (4 marks)

i) Which leadership style encourages innovation by allowing employees to make decisions with minimal supervision and offering them full autonomy?

A) Transactional

B) Laissez-faire

C) Democratic

D) Autocratic

Correct

B

ii) A leader inspires and motivates followers by setting a compelling vision, creating enthusiasm, and encouraging personal development. Which lead ership style best describes this behavior?

A) Transactional

B) Democratic

C) Transformational

D) Autocratic

Answer

C

14) Imagine you're leading a national service initiative in a rural community in Rwanda. Which one of the following activities is NOT best support to the com munity's educational development? (2 marks)

A) Building new school classrooms

B) Teaching practical life skills, such as financial literacy

C) Promoting exlusive education

D) Providing school supplies and materials to students

Correct

C

15) State whether each of the following statements is True or False. (6 marks)

a) Transport infrastructure reduces the cost of goods and services, making them more accessible to the population

True

b) Employment opportunities increase government tax revenue, leading to more funding for public services.

True

c) Transport networks isolate regions, preventing the flow of goods and labor, which hinders economic growth

False

d) Transport systems enable regional and international trade, leading to in creased exports and imports, and promoting economic growth

True

e) Employment in the informal sector has little impact on national economic development.

False

f) Job creation fosters a skilled workforce, improving productivity and contrib uting to economic growth.

True

Section B: Attempt only two questions (30 marks)

(Space in which to answer questions from this section is provided at the end of section C but for us we directly answer it here. Also we have corrected all questions instead of two questions)

16) Supposing your friend receives a short message service (SMS) or email from an unknown number and has the following message: You have won 250,000 Frw in the National Lottery Draw. Call +255012345 for further details on how to get your cash prize.

i) How would you treat such a text message or email? (2 marks):

The message should be treated as a highly suspicious phishing scam. You should immediately delete the SMS and block the unknown number. Do not click on any links or reply to the sender.

ii) Explain why it is dangerous for your friend to call an unknown number after receiving a message claiming they have won a prize. (2 marks)

Calling an unknown number can result in the caller being charged exorbitant premium rates. Furthermore, the scammer uses social engineering tactics to manipulate the victim into revealing sensitive financial data (like Mobile Money PINs or bank details), which leads to direct financial theft.

iii) Propose strategies that can be used to protect individuals from the financial scams (11 marks)

1. **Be careful with personal information**
Do not share your bank details, passwords, or PINs with anyone, especially online or on the phone.

2. **Use strong passwords**
Create passwords that are hard to guess and change them regularly.

3. **Verify before trusting**
Always confirm messages, calls, or emails that ask for money or information. Contact the official company directly.

4. **Avoid suspicious links**
Do not click on unknown links sent through email, SMS, or social media.

5. **Use secure websites**
Only enter your financial details on trusted websites (look for "https://").

5. **Keep your devices safe**
Install antivirus software and keep your phone or computer updated.

6. **Be careful of offers that seem too good**
If something promises quick money or huge rewards, it is likely a scam.

7. **Do not send money to strangers**
Avoid sending money to people you do not know or trust.

8. **Check your bank statements regularly**
This helps you notice any unusual transactions early.

9. **Educate yourself and others**
Learn about common scams and share the information with friends and family.

10. **Report suspicious activities**
Inform your bank or local authorities immediately if you suspect a scam.

17) Evaluate the value of communal work to social cohesion. (15 marks)

Communal work is when people in a community come together to do activities like cleaning, building, or helping each other. It plays an important role in promoting social cohesion (unity among people).

First, communal work **brings people together**. When individuals work as a group, they interact, communicate, and build strong relationships. This helps reduce isolation and strengthens unity.

Second, it **promotes cooperation and teamwork**. People learn to work with others, share responsibilities, and achieve common goals, which builds a spirit of togetherness.

Third, communal work **builds trust among community members**. When people help each other, they develop confidence and trust, which is important for peaceful living.

Fourth, it **reduces conflicts**. Working together helps people understand each other better, respect differences, and solve problems peacefully.

Fifth, it **encourages a sense of belonging**. Individuals feel that they are part of the community, which increases loyalty and participation in community activities.

Sixth, communal work **supports development**. Activities like building roads, schools, or cleaning the environment improve living conditions and benefit everyone.

Seventh, it **promotes shared values and culture**. People learn norms such as respect, responsibility, and unity through working together.

However, communal work may face challenges such as lack of participation, poor organization, or conflicts among members, which can reduce its effectiveness.

As conclusion, communal work is very valuable because it strengthens unity, trust, cooperation, and development in society. Therefore, it is an important tool for promoting social cohesion.

18) Write a job application letter for the position of a Receptionist at XYZ Corpora tion. Ensure that it contains all the parts.

Sender's Address
P.O. Box 1234
Kigali, Rwanda

Date: 10th April 2026

The Human Resource Manager
XYZ Corporation
P.O. Box 5678
Kigali, Rwanda

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: APPLICATION FOR THE POSITION OF RECEPTIONIST

I am writing to apply for the position of Receptionist at XYZ Corporation. I learned about this opportunity through your recent advertisement, and I am very interested in joining your organization.

I am a graduate with a qualification in Office Administration from ABC Institute. I possess strong communication and interpersonal skills, which enable me to interact effectively with

clients and visitors. I am also skilled in handling phone calls, scheduling appointments, and managing office records.

During my previous training, I gained experience in front office operations where I welcomed visitors, responded to inquiries, and ensured a professional working environment. I am computer literate and able to use common office applications efficiently.

I am a hardworking, honest, and well-organized individual who can work under minimal supervision. I am confident that I will contribute positively to the smooth running of your front office.

I have attached my curriculum vitae for your consideration. I would be grateful if I am given the opportunity to attend an interview.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,
Jane Doe
Tel: 0780000000
Email: janedoe@email.com

Section C: Attempt only one question (15 marks)

19) The following table shows the number of tourists and the number of cultural events in a particular region over five years (2016-2020).

Year	Number of tourists	Number of Cultural Events
20216	10	50
2017	12	55
2018	15	60
2019	18	70
2020	8	30

Correct answer

a) What is the average number of tourists per year from 2016 to 2020? (2 marks)

Total tourists = 10 + 12 + 15 + 18 + 8 = 63.

Average = 63 / 5 = 12.6 tourists

(in thousands/millions as per scale, or strictly 12.6 based on the raw data).

b) Can cultural events increase the number of tourists in a city? Explain briefly. (1 mark)

Yes. The data clearly shows a positive trend; as the number of cultural events increased from 50 in 2016 to 70 in 2019, the number of tourists concurrently rose from 10 to 18. Conversely, a sharp drop in events in 2020 led to a drop in tourists.

c) Rwanda has implemented several strategies to promote tourism through culture, identify atleast 2 strategies used. (3 marks)

1) Hosting high-profile annual cultural festivals like *Kwita Izina* (the gorilla naming ceremony) which integrates traditional performances.

2) Developing and marketing cultural heritage sites such as the King's Palace Museum in Nyanza and the Iby'Iwacu Cultural Village.

d) Identify 5 major cultural items in Rwanda. (5 marks)

1) Agaseke

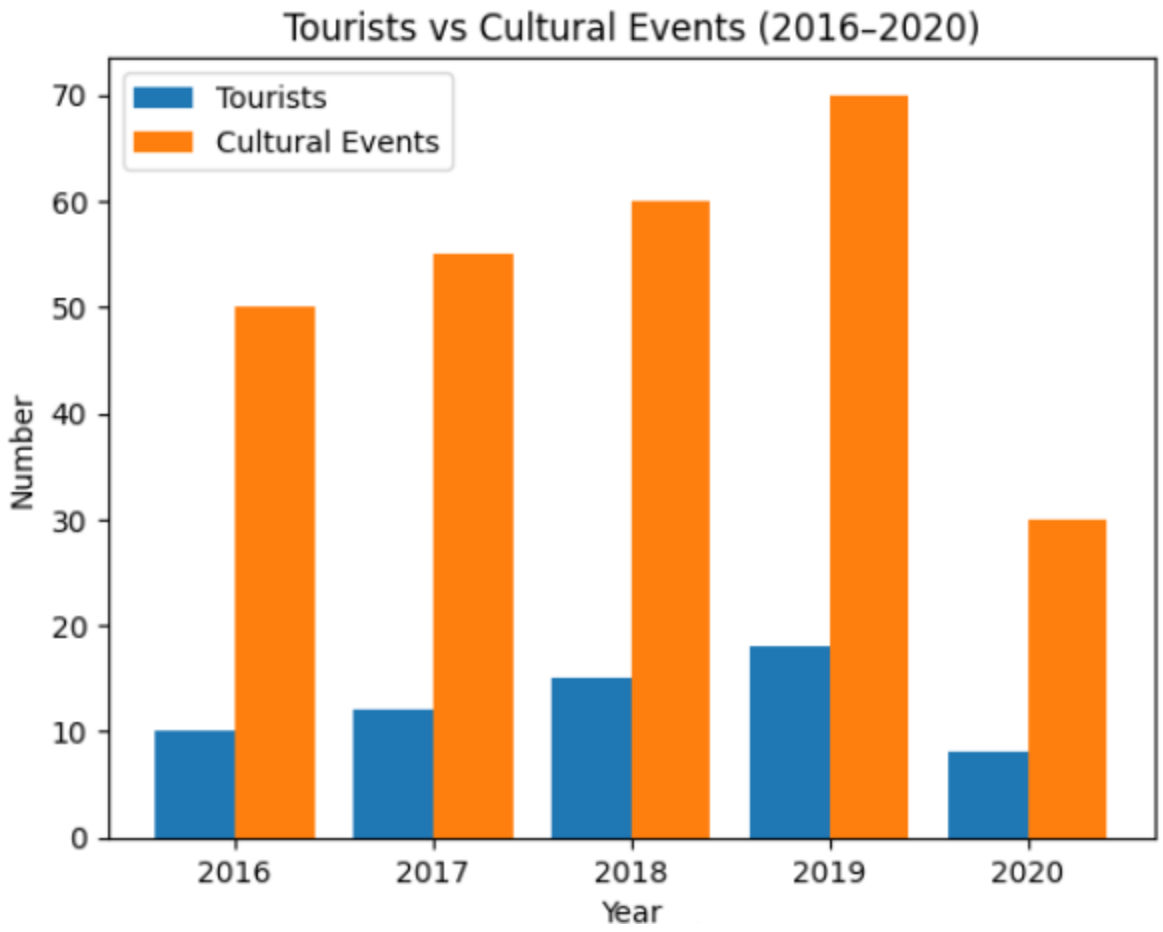
2. Imishanana

3. Inanga

4. Intore

5. Imigongo

e) Draw a simple bar graph to compare the number of tourists and cultural events each year(2016 to 2020) (4 marks)



20) Read the text below and then answer the questions that follow. (10 marks)

In the modern world, the relationship between media and commerce has become increasingly intertwined. Media is no longer just a platform for entertainment, information, and communication; it has also evolved into a significant tool for commercial activities. The integration of media and commerce has transformed the way businesses operate, interact with consumers, and market their products and services. This dynamic relationship has led to the rise of a new era of media and commerce, where advertising, branding, and consumer engagement play central roles in the media landscape.

One of the most prominent ways in which media and commerce are connected is through advertising. The advertising is a critical part of commercial activity, and the media serves as the primary platform for advertisers to reach a large and diverse audience. From traditional television and radio advertisements to online banners and social media ads, businesses use media channels to promote their products, services, and brands.

The power of advertising lies in its ability to influence consumer behavior. Through strategic placement in media, advertisements can shape consumer preferences, create demand, and drive sales. For example, during prime-time television slots, commercials for products ranging from

household goods to luxury cars can capture the attention of millions of viewers, potentially leading to an increase in sales.

With the advent of digital media, advertising has become more targeted and personalized. Social media platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and X (former Twitter) allow businesses to target specific demographics based on factors such as age, location, interests, and behavior. This shift to digital advertising has made media an even more powerful tool for driving commerce, as it allows businesses to engage with consumers in real time, gather feedback, and adjust marketing strategies accordingly.

Branding is another area where media and commerce are deeply connected. Media has the power to shape the perception of a brand by influencing how consumers view and relate to it. Through consistent media exposure, businesses can build strong, recognizable brands that resonate with their target audience. The media serves as the primary vehicle through which brands communicate their values, messages, and identity to consumers.

The concept of "brand identity" is crafted through advertising, public relations, and content creation, all of which are mediated through various media channels. For instance, a luxury brand like Gucci or Louis Vuitton relies heavily on media coverage, celebrity endorsements, and social media presence to reinforce its image of exclusivity and high-end fashion. Through media, these brands communicate a lifestyle and set of values that appeal to specific consumer groups.

Social media, in particular, has revolutionized branding by allowing businesses to directly engage with their audience in a more informal and interactive way. Companies now interact with customers through comments, direct messages, and user-generated content, creating a more personalized connection. Additionally, influencers and bloggers have become key figures in brand marketing, promoting products in ways that feel more organic and authentic compared to traditional advertisements.

E-commerce, or the buying and selling of goods and services online, is another major area where media and commerce intersect. The rise of e-commerce has been driven in large part by the proliferation of digital media, which has made it easier for businesses to reach consumers and for consumers to access products. Websites, mobile apps, and social media platforms serve as digital storefronts, where businesses can market their products and interact with potential buyers.

The relationship between media and e-commerce is also evident in the integration of shopping features on social media platforms like Instagram and Facebook. These platforms now allow users to browse and purchase products directly within the app, merging the worlds of social interaction and shopping. Influencers play a key role in driving e-commerce sales by showcasing products to their followers and providing links for easy purchasing.

Furthermore, targeted advertising has made online shopping experiences more personalized. For example, if a consumer searches for a pair of shoes on a website, they may see ads for those shoes or similar products pop up on their social media feeds, encouraging them to complete their purchase. This targeted advertising is powered by data collected from users' online activities, creating a cycle of personalized recommendations and media exposure that drives commerce.

As the media landscape has expanded, so too has the way consumers interact with it. Today, media consumption is no longer limited to passive activities like watching TV or listening to the radio. Consumers are now active participants in the media landscape, engaging with content on social media, reading online reviews, and interacting with brands directly. This shift in consumer behavior has transformed how businesses approach marketing and commerce.

For example, online reviews and ratings have become essential in shaping consumer purchasing decisions. A positive review on a website or a favorable recommendation on social media can lead to a boost in sales, while negative feedback can damage a brand's reputation. Businesses must now monitor their online presence and respond to customer inquiries and complaints in real time to maintain a positive image.

Additionally, the rise of influencer marketing has changed the way brands con nect with consumers. Consumers trust influencers, often more than traditional advertisements, because the influencers appear more relatable and authentic. Influencers help brands create a narrative that resonates with their followers, making the marketing feel less like advertising and more like a personal recommendation.

The intersection of media and commerce has fundamentally changed the way businesses market their products, build their brands, and engage with consumers. Advertising, branding, e-commerce, and consumer behavior are all influenced by the media, which has become a vital tool for businesses looking to expand their reach and drive sales. As digital and social media continue to evolve, businesses must adapt their strategies to stay relevant and engage effectively with consumers. The future of media and commerce will likely see even more integration of media platforms with commercial activities, creating new opportunities and challenges for businesses and consumers alike.

Questions on the text:

Circle the letter that corresponds to the correct answer.

1) i) What is the primary role of the media in commerce?

A) To drive sales and promote products through advertising

B) To limit consumer access to products

C) To entertain consumers

D) To create content that only informs the audience

Correct

A

ii) How has digital advertising changed the role of media in commerce? (1 mark)

A) It has become less personalized

B) It has made advertising more targeted and personalized

C) It has removed the need for media in commerce

D) It has decreased the effectiveness of advertising

Correct

B

iii) What is branding, and how is it connected to media? (1 mark)

A) The process of selling products at a higher price

B) The creation of a company's identity and reputation through media

C) The process of hiding a brand's values

D) The process of limiting media exposure to a brand

Answer

B

iv) How has e-commerce benefited from the rise of digital media? (1 mark)

A) By making it harder for businesses to reach consumers

B) By decreasing the availability of products online

C) By limiting product recommendations to offline stores

D) By creating online shopping platforms like websites, apps, and social media

Answer

D

v) How has consumer behavior shifted in relation to media consumption? (1 mark)

A) Consumers are now passive participants in media

B) Consumers have stopped engaging with brands altogether

C) Consumers are more active, engaging with content and directly interacting with brands

D) Consumers only engage with television and radio content

Correct

C

2) In not more than 50 words, summarize what the author said about Media and Commerce.

The author argues that media is fundamentally intertwined with commerce, acting as a crucial platform for advertising, branding, and e-commerce. Digital advancements have transformed consumers into active participants, forcing businesses to utilize highly targeted, personalized marketing strategies to successfully engage audiences and drive sales.